

## Prevention

Cyberbullying is fairly common among children and teens, but there are ways to reduce the risk and limit its impact. Keeping passwords and personal information private is good practice in general, as is being cautious over what a person posts online—both images and text. A person should also always check their security options and privacy settings on any social media platforms.



### △ Active steps

There are many sources of information and advice to help teens and parents prevent and deal with cyberbullying if it happens to them or someone they know.

### TEEN HINTS

#### Taking action

If cyberbullying is affecting you or someone you know, there are things you can do.

- Tell an adult you can trust.
- Keep a diary of what the bullies do, including dates and descriptions, or screenshots as evidence.
- Don't retaliate—bullies seek attention, so they will lose interest if there is no response.
- Contact service providers about bullying coming from within their network. Some have report buttons specifically dedicated to cyberbullying reports.
- Block anyone who makes you feel uncomfortable.

## Recognizing cyberbullying

A person might be a cyberbully without realizing it. While somebody may share a comment or picture "as a joke" or simply to get a lot of likes, it's important that they consider their post carefully from all angles to ensure it isn't personally offensive to an individual. Whether it's due to not thinking or actively being mean—and even if it's in response to another cyberbully—posting or sending victimizing comments or messages about other people is cyberbullying.



### △ Don't get involved

Cyberbullying is not acceptable. Many countries have passed laws that identify cyberbullying as a crime.

## Online hate

Unfortunately, there are many forms of hate, including misogyny (disliking or being prejudiced against women), racism, and homophobia, as well as many ways of showing that hate, such as body shaming and insulting people. Much of this hate can find its way onto the Internet and public websites. Whether the hate is explicitly worded or insinuated through its exclusion of certain people, online hate is a worldwide problem that can easily filter into an individual's online browsing, and should always be reported to the appropriate service provider.

### GOOD TO KNOW

#### Trolling

There is a thin line between cyberbullying and trolling. Cyberbullying repeatedly targets a specific victim to intimidate them in some way, while the intent behind trolling is to provoke reactions. Trolling is as ugly as its name suggests, and usually takes the form of inflammatory and offensive comments. While it may feel like a personal attack for the person or people that it affects, trolling is about annoying as many people as possible into responding and voicing their annoyance. The best way to deal with attention-seeking trolling is to deny it the attention that it seeks.

